



MSC
CRUISES

STATEMENT WIN

Lando Norris **extended his lead** at the top with a solid win at the Brazilian Grand Prix.

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In the sacred land of Ayrton Senna, spectacular racing feels almost inevitable. Last year's Brazilian Grand Prix only strengthened that belief. In treacherous, rain-soaked conditions, Max Verstappen delivered a masterclass in control and conviction, charging from 17th on the grid to a commanding victory at Interlagos.

By the chequered flag, he had completed one of Formula One's great recoveries, which all but marked the end of Lando Norris' valiant title pursuit, as the reigning world champion once again proved untouchable when it mattered most.

A year later, the storied circuit was the perfect stage for an overtaking fest, some rewarding and some repenting. For Norris (**above**), the inability to brave pressure situations had proven costly all too many times, but he showed the world that he can, and has, become a changed competitor.

Calm, composed, and perfectly in tune with his McLaren, he stayed clear of the high-octane action just behind. There was never the haunting sight of the Dutchman in his mirrors as Norris coasted to his 11th victory, grabbing the maximum 33 points available in the weekend.

The double triumph — in the sprint and main race — extended his lead over a struggling Oscar Piastri, whose difficult outing left him 24 points behind at the top and only 25 ahead of Verstappen in third.

Pitlane, puncture, podium

While Norris stood atop the podium, admiration flowed for the man on the third step — Verstappen. To rebound from his worst qualifying in years and complete a rare pitlane-to-podium drive was no small feat. Overcoming an early puncture, he mounted an unforgettable charge through the field, keeping himself firmly in title contention.

A disappointing 16th place in Saturday's qualifying had confirmed Red Bull's setup woes. The team seized the opportunity to implement radical changes and install a new engine, resulting in a compulsory pitlane start. But memories of his P17-to-P1 charge at this very circuit last year lingered. With that confidence and "nothing to lose", Verstappen attacked relentlessly, picking off rivals one by one until only two cars separated him from the lead.

Approaching in red-hot form, any driver would be wary of the imminent